

Fair Opportunity Exception (FOE) Limited Source Justification and Approval (J&A)

(For use when limiting sources IAW 16.505(b)(2))

Project/Program Name: Mission Planning Support Engineering (MPSE) Services Component/PEO/Other: PEO-SOF Digital Applications (SDA) Estimated Contract Cost (including options): \$6,539,436.76 J&A Basic Value: \$6,539,436.76	FOE J&A No. 25 - 3976
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1. Agency and Contracting Activity: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(1))

(U) HQ USSOCOM/SOF AT&L-SOF DIGITAL APPLICATIONS
7701 TAMPA POINT BLVD
MACDILL AFB, FL 33621

(U) HQ USSOCOM/SOF AT&L-KD
7701 TAMPA POINT BLVD
MACDILL AFB, FL 33621

2. Description of Action: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(3)) Bridge Action (Yes ☒)

(U) This Justification and Approval (J&A) approves the issuance of a bridge task order based on other than full and open competition to Sawdey Solution Services, Cage Code 1TWX6. The task order type will be Cost Plus Fixed Fee. Special Operations Mission Planning and Execution (SOMPE) requires continued support for Mission Planning and Execution activities for USSOCOM components and Theater Special Operations Commands (TSOC) while a new contract is being competed. The need for continued support requires the issuance of a three (3) month bridge task order with an additional three (3) – one (1) month option periods to meet mission requirements while on-going competition for the follow-on acquisition is being completed. The resulting contract award does not allow SOF ATL sufficient time to properly transition the program to the new contract. Consequently, an additional bridge TO will be needed to ensure continuity of critical mission planning services across the SOF enterprise avoiding real-world mission failure for Global SOF.

(U) The current task order (H9241524F0068) was awarded by SOF AT&L in June 2024 as a nine (9) month bridge task order with no options or extensions. The current period of performance for the task order is 01 July 2024 through 31 March 2025. The original task order was awarded in 2019 which included a base year with 4 option years and a 6-month extension. This task order was awarded by Army Contracting Command off the GSA OASIS SB MAC IDIQ. At the beginning of Option Year 3, administration of the task order was transferred to SOF AT&L and the order number was updated to H9241522F0004. The task order's 6-month extension had already been exercised by Army Contracting Command prior to the task order being transferred to SOF AT&L. The new requirement is not going to be awarded on time to prevent a break in service but is planned to be awarded before September 2025.

The new task order will bridge the three (3) to six (6) month gap between the current task order and the new, competed contract. The bridge will allow continuity of critical mission planning services consequently avoiding real-world mission failure of Global SOF forces. The total estimated value for this acquisition is \$6,539,436.76 in Operations and Maintenance funding. Additionally, the rates from the current MPSE Task Order, H9241524F0080, were taken into consideration when developing the estimated value.

3. Description of Supplies/Services: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(2))

(U) This bridge task order is for professional and technical support services for Special Operations Mission Planning activities. The services consist of on-site mission planning & execution systems maintenance and training support for USSOCOM components () and the . System support services is provided at varying support elements and locations in five (5) major areas: Operational Software Support, Mapping, Imagery and Geospatial Information System Support, Operational Network Administration Support, Training Support and Enhancement and Upgrade Support.

4. Authority Cited Permitting Limited Sources or Fair Opportunity Exception and Rationale: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(4))

☒ FAR 16.505(b)(2)(i)(C), "The order must be issued on a sole-source basis in the interest of economy and efficiency because it is a logical follow-on to an order already issued under the contract, provided that all awardees were given a fair opportunity to be considered for the original order".

(U) USSOCOM has a continuing need for Mission Planning Support Engineering Services. The current task order was issued on a sole-source basis to Sawdey Solution Services in the interest of economy and efficiency because it was a logical follow-on to an order already issued under the contract. The Task Order period of performance ends on 31 March 2025.

(U) Sawdey Solution Services is the current contractor knowledgeable in the mission planning support engineer services required for SOMPE mission planning and execution throughout the [REDACTED]. Sawdey has been in place since July 2019; providing professional and technical support services for Special Operations Mission Planning activities across the SOF enterprise. Sawdey is experienced in the specialized the technical and analytical mission planning and execution systems support. Sawdey Solution Services has been exposed to the critical intricacies of mission planning processes and procedures.

(U) The bridge task order requires [REDACTED] Full Time Equivalents (FTE) at a CONUS and OCONUS locations. These individuals have been performing these services and have acquired subject matter expertise and situational awareness of mission planning services and the SOF mission.

(U) The bridge task order is a logical follow-on to the expiring task order. The scope of this bridge task order is identical to the current MPSE contract. All offerors were given fair opportunity to compete on the original task order. In the interest of efficiency, it is best to have Sawdey Solution Services continue to provide the services while the next, competitive, contract is being finished. By continuing to have Sawdey Solution Services perform this requirement the government is going to realize stabilized performance vice having a new contractor attempt to phase in, transition personnel, learn the contract, and then finally start to perform to the level that is required. The short period of this bridge task order will not allow another contractor to become fully proficient on delivering the required services. The government would lose the efficiencies gained during the last 5+ years of the current task order with no benefit going forward. Not only would this cause a degradation of service, but the short nature of this bridge task order increases a new contractor's risk to personnel employment and there would be a price premium paid above and beyond the price of having Sawdey Solution Services continue to provide the required services in the short term.

5. Efforts/Actions to Increase Competition: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(7))

(U) The forthcoming, competed contract action is for the Global Systems Support Engineers (GSSE) requirement, a new requirement that will encompass and supersede the current MPSE requirement. The primary focus of GSSE is to cross-trained personnel that can operate in multiple domains, one of which being the domain of the current MPSE contract. A bridge contract is required to have time to award GSSE while still ensuring that MPSE services are still operational so as not to experience substantial mission degradation.

(U) Market research to survey industry's ability to meet the new requirement has been concluded. This bridge task order is a one-time requirement in lieu of the competitive follow-on contract being protested. The subsequent action is currently being competed and is expected to be awarded in FY25. The GSSE contract was originally to be awarded by the end of the current MPSE task order; however, growth and changing

requirements added an additional layer of complexity to the requirement. Additionally, ambiguity in the GSSE's RFP drove a proposal extension for all vendors and the SSEB team was delayed in the completion of their technical evaluation and analysis due to two mandatory hurricane evacuations in September/October that resulted in widespread damage to MacDill AFB and the surrounding cities to include flooding, loss of power, and other water damage that caused personnel disruption for several months. This led to the loss of 14 business days and additional time to make living conditions suitable for living upon return from mandatory evacuations. Also, the departure of the primary executing personnel on the recompete effort and the need to find a replacement Procuring Contracting Officer (PCO) contributed to the delays.

(U) As stated above, to overcome barriers to entry, the government is competing the requirement going forward with the intent of setting the requirement aside for small businesses. This will allow companies to partner with one another and use one another's experience to be successful in working on this requirement in the future. The new requirement is not going to be awarded on time to prevent a break in service but is planned to be awarded before September 2025.

6. Market Research: (FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(vi))

(U) A Request for Information (RFI) for similar capabilities, the updated requirement GSSE, was posted in October 2023 which yielded several results. PM SOF Mission Command and Intel performed a comprehensive review of those submissions as a basis for this bridge task order. There were [REDACTED] submissions ([REDACTED] Large/[REDACTED] Small businesses) for this RFI; however, to fulfill this particular requirement it was determined that no company, other than Sawdey Solution Services, would be able to satisfy the requirement. Additionally, the Engage SOF (eSOF) database was also reviewed as a part of this market research. No vendors were found within the eSOF database who would be able to provide the required services in the short turnaround window without a disruption/degradation to critical mission services.

(U) In order to ascertain whether or not vendors would now be capable of performing the requirement without the loss of efficiencies as well as substantial learning and re-work, internet searches have continuously been conducted. This is in addition to contact with industry partners that perform, or may be able to perform, in this field.

(U) The most recent market research occurred in November 2024 in which a review of numerous potential vendors yielded the conclusion that the award of this contract to a vendor other than the incumbent would undeniably result in a loss to efficiencies gained over the last 4 years of the task order and would require substantial learning and re-work by a new vendor in order to properly perform the requirement. With the short nature of this bridge task order and the above analysis, it makes logical sense to award the bridge task order to Sawdey Solution Services for the three (3) month period with a three (3) month option period in the interest of economy and efficiency.

7. Interested Sources:

(U) As stated above, [REDACTED] capability statements were received in response to RFI H9241524RFI01 for similar capabilities, posted October 2023 on sam.gov. Of those submissions only Sawdey Solution Services has the capability to fulfill the requirement and provide the level of service that the government needs in the short term until a competitive contract is awarded. Submissions were received from [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

While other sources could ultimately satisfy the current requirement no other sources could satisfy these requirements in the short suspense or timely manner without disruption in the current support and unacceptable schedule delays.

8. Other Facts Supporting the Justification: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(6))

- N/A

[REDACTED]

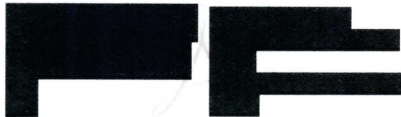


9. Technical and Requirements Certification: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(9))

I certify that the supporting data under my cognizance which are included in the justification are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief:

NAME: 

TITLE: 

SIGNATURE: 

DATE:





10. Fair and Reasonable Cost Determination: (FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(7), DFARS 216.505-70(d)(3))

Upon receipt of Sawdey Solution Services' proposal, I hereby determine that the anticipated cost or price to the Government for this contract action will be fair and reasonable. The pricing of the current services is currently available for comparison and it is expected that prices will remain similar with a probable escalation rate due to inflation.

CONTRACTING OFFICER SIGNATURE IN SECTION 11 BELOW ALSO SERVES AS THE PRICE FAIR AND REASONABLENESS DETERMINATION IN THIS SECTION.

11. Contracting Officer Certification: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(8))

I hereby certify that this J&A is complete and accurate to the best of my knowledge and belief.

NAME: Michael F. White

TITLE: SOF AT&L-KD Contracting Officer

SIGNATURE:



DATE: _____





12. Legal: (SOFARS 5601-1)

Legal review complete (see legal review):

NAME: [REDACTED] [REDACTED]

SIGNATURE: [REDACTED] [REDACTED] DATE: _____

[REDACTED]



**13. Head of Contracting Division (HCD): (FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(10),
SOFARS 5601-1)**

I have reviewed this document and find the J&A adequate to support other than full
and open competition:

NAME: [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

SIGNATURE: [REDACTED] [REDACTED] DATE: _____

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]



14. Approval:

(FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(C)(2), SOFARS 5601-1)

Based upon the foregoing justification, I hereby approve the procurement of Mission Planning Support Engineering in the estimated amount of \$6.6M. The requirement will be released under solicitation TBD on an other than full and open competition basis. The action(s) pursuant to this J&A are subject to the availability of funds and the completion of all required statutory and regulatory reviews and approvals.

NAME: [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

SIGNATURE: [REDACTED] [REDACTED] DATE: _____

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]